

and putting systems in place. "I have a business brain, too. But it is good to have a top B-school graduate taking care of that while I focus purely on design," he laughs.

The new JV brand (name still to be decided) will grow both vertically and horizontally in the fields of accessories, footwear, home, beauty, and jewellery for a worldwide audience.

The ABFRL-Tarun Tahiliani partnership led to the first Tasva store opening in Bengaluru in December 2021. It currently operates nine stores across five cities including Mumbai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Bengaluru as well as Indore. It has massive expansion plans and there are likely to be 75 Tasva stores across the country by March 2023. Tahiliani says Tasva is a long-time dream of his that has become possible because of ABFRL.

60 |

SAHNI SAYS THAT with their ethnic ready-to-wear offerings, designers and retail conglomerates are trying to attract the next 10-15 per cent of the population that has the money but is not looking for couture. "Market expansion will happen because the next layer of the market is far larger in terms of numbers and they also have money."

In October last year, Reliance Retail Ventures Ltd (RRVL) acquired a 52 per cent stake in fashion designer Ritu Kumar's Ritika Pvt. Ltd that owns Ritu Kumar, Label Ritu Kumar, RI Ritu Kumar, aarké, and Ritu Kumar Home and Living. Amrish Kumar, designer Ritu Kumar's son and Managing Director of Reliance Ritu Kumar (the way the company is referred to post the acquisition), says that RRVL brings with it a whole lot of skill sets and operational knowhow that are very beneficial.

"Access to capital and the ability to take the kind of decisions that give you long-term benefits is one key advantage. Plus, they have a lot of brands, so dovetailing with what they are doing, we get better rates and better access." Kumar says that while aarké, their latest brand meant to reach a larger consumer base, contributes to revenue in single digits, they expect it to grow exponentially. Currently, the Ritu Kumar brand is the largest and contributes around 35-37 per cent to the total revenue followed by Label, which is about 30 per cent, and then bridal brand RI at about 18-20 per cent.

ABFRL, which intends to craft a portfolio that



PHOTOS BY BANDEEP SINGH

▲

"If you have to dream of establishing a global brand out of India, it has to be ready-to-wear. RBL will help us achieve scale... We are looking at an omnichannel presence in cities like London and Paris"

Rahul Mishra
FOUNDER AND CREATIVE
DIRECTOR, RAHUL MISHRA
DESIGNS PVT. LTD